Andrew Nakamoto

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Education

University of Washington — Seattle, WA

Masters and Bachelors of Science in Computer Science — *Sep. 2022 – Jun. 2026*

GPA: 4.00 - Summa Cum Laude

- CSE 446: Machine Learning, CSE 447: Natural Language Processing, and CSE 573: Artificial Intelligence.
- CSE 332: Data Structures and Parallelism, CSE 421: Algorithms, and CSE 333: Systems Programming.
- CSE 452: Distributed Systems, CSE 461: Networks, and MATH 318: Advanced Linear Algebra.

Experience

Google DeepMind

Software Engineer Intern — *June 2025 – September 2025*

Production engineering for Gemini at Google DeepMind for a multimodal AI assistant with app integrations.
Shipped core new backend functionality for Gemini App's tool infrastructure using C++ for 400M MAU.
Improved core journey favorability by 11% building and iterating on new multimodal datasets in Python.

Meta

Software Engineer Intern — *June 2024 – September 2024*

Research team at Meta FAIR (Fundamental AI Research) focused on reasoning, alignment, and memory.
Implementing configurable functionality to use the latest preference optimization methods (DPO, SimPO, CPO, ORPO, etc.) for LLM alignment in Meta's popular open-source fairseq2 toolkit using Python and PyTorch.
Writing internal FAIR tooling in Python and C++ for local instruction-following task evaluation.
Researching the impact of PO loss variations and PEFT on LLM reasoning, alignment, and memory.

DubHacks

Executive Director — *February 2023 – February 2025*

Led a team of 20 designers and software engineers while overseeing a $110k+ annual budget.
Implemented front end, back end, and full stack solutions using MySQL, React, Docker, and Google Suite APIs.
Directed the 2024 event for over 1000 participants and industry professionals.

UW Allen School Mobile Intelligence Lab

Research Assistant — *January 2024 – May 2025*

Researched machine learning optimization techniques for active noise-cancellation and target-speech isolation.
Built an iOS application with Swift, Objective-C, Python, PyTorch, and Onnx by integrating neural nets to identify characteristic speech traits from target voices in noisy environments and cancel non-target noise in binaural audio.

Projects

DubHacks Judging: Wrote and deployed an application for over 600 users to automate judging for DubHacks 2024. Processed API data, wrote a mapping algorithm for assignments, and built tooling to send automated messages to users and visualize progess. Used Docker, Google Suite APIs, Python, Discord APIs, and MySQL.

Webserver Search Engine: Built a complete web application and server using C and C++ that serves a webpage interface, accepts client search requests, finds relevant documents and webpages in its index, then serves a response over the internet. Used C, C++, HTTP, TCP/IP, POSIX, Unix/Linux, and DNS protocols.

Sci-Fact LLM: Experimented with several large language model strategies for the OpenBookQA benchmark. Built and fine-tuned a RAG fact-retrieval model that achieved near-human 85% accuracy on the dataset despite limited compute. Used Python, PyTorch, Google Colab, and HuggingFace. Summary paper available on GitHub.

Skills & Passions

Languages & Tools: Java, Python, C, C++, Swift, HTML/CSS, TypeScript, JavaScript, C#, React, Node.js, PyTorch, HuggingFace, SQL, MySQL, PostgreSQL, Git, TCP/ICP, Linux/Unix, Microsoft Azure SQL Database.

Passions: Machine learning, data science, linear algebra, distributed systems and networks, NLP, system design.

Hobbies: Camping/hiking, outdoor conservation, nonprofit management and community engagement, guitar. I love travelling, eating, and organizing big events. Ask me about my favorite tarp shelters!